

8.4 Internet Culture

8.4.1 404

Based on the infamous 404 error thrown by a Web server (see §7.3, *General Internet Terms*) the term has moved into general usage where you might say “I’ve drawn a 404,” meaning “I’ve drawn a blank.”

8.4.2 Affiliate

One of the cornerstones of Internet marketing. Web site affiliates and affiliate programs are used to generate leads and sales of both physical and digital download products. The affiliate industry has evolved into a multi-million dollar sector. Affiliates normally earn commission on each item that’s sold by the site owner. The Internet has made it extremely easy to track users who have come to the site through the referral of a specific affiliate member.

8.4.3 Beta Software

This has become *de facto* on the Web! Every new startup’s site is in beta, probably having taken the lead from Google’s Gmail service. In actual fact, beta software is one of the stages of testing a software where the software (or site) is released to a limited number of developers for live testing and reporting on bugs, crashes, errors, and other such problems. Software creation being a complex process, it is inevitable that the testers will not catch all the bugs. Thus, Web sites and software companies make the beta software available to the public to aid them in their testing process. Due to the large number of users testing the software simultaneously, more and more bugs will be quickly discovered. This phenomenon led to the coining of the phrase: “Given enough eyeballs, all bugs are shallow,” as stated by Linus Torvalds, the creator of the Linux operating system.

8.4.4 Bounced message

Typically, an e-mail message that was not delivered and was “bounced” back to the inbox of the sender.